



A native of Little Rock, Arkansas, **Dr. Tom Bolton** earned a Bachelor of Music degree in vocal performance from Ouachita Baptist University and a Master of Music and Doctor of Philosophy in musicology from the University of North Texas. His long professional career includes college and seminary teaching, church ministry, and professional solo performances in operatic roles and guest appearances with symphony orchestras. He was professor of music at Ouachita Baptist University in Arkadelphia, Arkansas from 1973 to 1989 and minister of music at Little Rock's First Baptist Church from 1989 to 1996. In 1996 his educational and ministerial roles were combined when he accepted the position of Professor of Church Music at The Southern Baptist Theological Seminary in Louisville, Kentucky. In 2000 he was named Dean of the School of Church Music and Worship, retiring in 2012 and moving to Hot Springs, Arkansas to be near family. In retirement he has taught voice as well as music history and worship classes at Ouachita Baptist University and Champion Christian College. He has served as Minister of Music at Lake Hamilton Baptist Church since 2015 and has been the musical director of The Village Chorale since 2018.

*Our next program will be Sunday, April 12 at 3:00pm
First United Methodist Church Cupp Hall*

Sound in Motion: Dance to the Music

The Hot Springs Music Connection raises money to provide scholarships to students from Garland County who are pursuing music-related degrees in college. HSMC is affiliated with the National Federation of Music Clubs, which provides opportunities for musical study, performance, and appreciation to more than 90,000 senior, student, and junior members in 5,200 music-related clubs and organizations nationwide. It is chartered by the Congress of the United States and is the only music organization member of the United Nations.

Dedicated to finding and fostering young musical talent, the NFMC conducts annual Junior Festivals with approximately 100,000 participants. It offers more than three quarters of a million dollars in state and national competitions, including four \$20,000 biennial Young Artist awards, and the \$20,000 Ellis Award for Duo-Pianists. The Young Artist and Ellis Duo Piano awards include two years of performance bookings.



HOT SPRINGS MUSIC CONNECTION

SANCTUARY OF SOUND

MUSIC FOR THE CHURCH

2025-2026 Season

*First Presbyterian Church
March 15, 2026
3:00 p.m.*

Sanctuary of Sound: Music for the Church

Welcome Dianna Thayer, Program Chair

Program Introduction.....Dr. Tom Bolton, President

Program

The Gift of LoveArranged by Kevin McChesney

First Presbyterian Church Handbell Choir
Dr. Ian Aipperspach, Director

It Is Well with My Soul..... Words: Horatio Spafford
Music: Phillip Bliss
Arranged by Craig Courtney
Laura Carlson, flute

Precious Lord Words and Music: Thomas Dorsey
Arranged by Arnold Sevier

Come, Ye Sinners Poor and Needy Words: Joseph Hart
Music: American Folk Tune
Arranged by Heather Sorenson

The Village Chorale
Dr. Tom Bolton, Director
Kristen La Madrid, Collaborative Pianist

Be Thou My Vision.....Arr. D. Linda McKechnie

Jesus, What a Friend for SinnersArr. D. Linda McKechnie

Dr. Ian Aipperspach, organ
Kristen La Madrid, piano

Toccata on “Amazing Grace”J. Christopher Pardini

From *Rubrics*Dan Locklair

The Peace May Be Exchanged

Dr. Ian Aipperspach, organ



Dr. Ian Aipperspach serves as organist and handbell director at First Presbyterian Church and is Associate Professor of Music at Ouachita Baptist University. He holds an undergraduate degree from John Brown University, a Master of Music in Church Music (Conducting and Organ Performance) from Southwestern Baptist Theological Seminary, and a Ph.D. in Fine Arts (Choral Conducting) from Texas Tech University. His diverse experience includes work as a chorusmaster with orchestras and directing productions in music theatre and opera.



Kristen La Madrid serves as Coordinator of Accompanists in the Division of Music at Ouachita Baptist University, supporting faculty and student recitals and teaching within the music program. A graduate of La Sierra University (B.A., Piano) and the University of Miami (M.M., Collaborative Piano), she remains active throughout the region as both performer and teacher. La Madrid is a member of the Muses Performance Troupe and has appeared with ensembles including the Arkansas Jazz Orchestra and the Stardust Big Band. She also serves as pianist and organist for area churches and maintains a private piano studio in the Hot Springs and Arkadelphia communities.